Amerimed
WELLNESS INSTITUTE

Amerimed Wellness Institute
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PATIENT FINANCIAL SERVICES · AMW-PAT-004

Billing, Payments & Price Transparency Policy

Estimates, insurance billing, surprise-billing protections, payment options and refunds

Document ID	AMW-PAT-004	**Version**	3.2
Effective date	2026-03-01	**Next review**	2027-03-01
Policy owner	Kenji Watanabe, VP Revenue Cycle & Patient Financial Services	**Approved by**	Marcus Bell, Chief Financial Officer
Applies to	All patients and guarantors of Amerimed facilities and employed providers	**Classification**	Public

1. Price transparency

- **Standard charges file:** a machine-readable file of gross charges, discounted cash prices, payer-specific negotiated rates and de-identified minimum and maximum rates for all items and services. It is published on our website and updated at least annually (45 CFR Part 180, using the CMS template).
- **Shoppable services:** a consumer-friendly display of 300+ shoppable services (e.g. MRI, colonoscopy, normal delivery), or an online **price estimator tool**.
- **Cash price discount:** self-pay patients without insurance automatically receive a **40% discount** off gross charges, or the financial-assistance discount if greater (AMW-PAT-003).

2. Good Faith Estimates (No Surprises Act)

If you are **uninsured or choose not to use insurance**, you have the right to a **Good Faith Estimate** of the total expected cost of scheduled care:

When you schedule	We provide the estimate within
3+ business days before the service	1 business day after scheduling
10+ business days before the service	3 business days after scheduling
On request (no appointment yet)	3 business days

If your bill is **USD 400 or more above** your Good Faith Estimate, you can start a federal **patient-provider dispute resolution** process within 120 days of the bill date. Your right to dispute does not depend on whether you have paid.

3. Surprise-billing protections

When you get emergency care, or are treated by an out-of-network provider at an in-network Amerimed hospital, you are protected from **balance billing**. You pay only your in-network cost-sharing (copays, coinsurance, deductibles). - Out-of-network providers (e.g. anesthesiology, radiology, pathology, emergency medicine, hospitalists) **cannot** ask you to waive these protections. - **California AB 72** and **AB 1611** (emergency services), **Oregon ORS 743B.287** and the **Washington Balance Billing Protection Act** add state protections. - Questions: the No Surprises Help Desk, 1-800-985-3059, or the California Department of Managed Health Care Help Center.

4. Insurance billing

- Amerimed bills your health plan directly when you provide valid insurance information at or before registration.
- We are in network with major commercial plans, Medicare and Medicare Advantage, Medi-Cal managed care plans, the Oregon Health Plan (CCOs) and Apple Health MCOs. See our website for the current list.
- **Prior authorisation:** our access team requests authorisation for scheduled services. If authorisation is denied, we will contact you before the service.
- Claims are submitted within 7 days of service. You will receive a statement only after your insurer processes the claim.

5. Statements and payment options

- **One consolidated statement** for hospital and physician services, in plain language, with an itemised bill available on request.
- **Payment due:** 30 days from the first statement date.
- **Ways to pay:** MyAmerimed portal (card, ACH, Apple Pay, Google Pay), phone (1-888-555-0127), mail (Amerimed Patient Financial Services, P.O. Box 5552, San Jose, CA 95150), or in person at any cashier.
- **Interest-free payment plans:** up to 24 months for balances over USD 300, with no credit check. Longer plans are available with financial counselling.
- **Prompt-pay discount:** 10% off self-pay balances paid in full within 30 days of the first statement (not combined with the financial-assistance discount).

6. Statement cycle

Day (from first statement)	Action
0	First statement, with the financial-assistance summary
30	Second statement
60	Third statement + phone outreach
90	Final notice, with a list of available assistance
120+	Account may be placed with an early-out servicer (who acts as Amerimed, with no credit reporting)
180+	Earliest date for any extraordinary collection action (not used in California - see AMW-PAT-003)

7. Refunds and credit balances

- Overpayments are refunded **within 30 days** of identification (California: with interest at 10% per annum if not refunded within 30 days, per Health & Safety Code 127440).
- Refunds go to the original payment method or by check to the guarantor.
- Credit balances owed to Medicare or Medicaid are reported and repaid within **60 days** of identification (ACA Section 6402).

8. Medical debt and credit reporting

Amerimed does **not** report medical debt to consumer credit reporting agencies at any facility. Debts of less than USD 500, or under one year old, were never reportable under the national credit bureau policy.

9. Billing questions and disputes

Patient Financial Services: 1-888-555-0127 (Mon-Fri 7:00 am-7:00 pm PT; Sat 8:00 am-12:00 pm PT) | billing@amerimedwellness.example. Disputed balances are placed on hold during review, and we respond within **30 days**.

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